Robert Guss

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Front-End Engineer with proven experience building scalable web experiences, modernizing toolchains, and championing developer experience. My expertise includes React, TypeScript, Cypress, Next.js, and Tailwind CSS. I also have a deep understanding of testing and automation. Demonstrated ability to collaborate with product teams, deliver customer-centric solutions, and improve developer onboarding through documentation and training initiatives.

SKILLS

React | Vue.js | XState | HTML | CSS | JavaScript |TypeScript | Tailwind CSS | Next.js | Git | Cypress | Python | PHP | Node.js | Docker | Linux | WordPress | Agile/Scrum | Mobile Optimization

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Front-End Engineer and Solutions Engineer | March 2023 - January 2024
Airplane Labs | Remote

Recently acquired by Airtable, Airplane is a platform for building UIs and internal tools for engineering, support, and operations teams.

- Developed and optimized responsive landing pages for airplane.dev (including the landing page used to launch on Product Hunt) using Next.js, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS, leading to a significant increase in user signups and demos booked.
- Accelerated customer onboarding and streamlined processes by developing custom views, tasks, and templates using React, TypeScript, Python, and SQL. Provided technical consultations to tailor solutions to unique customer requirements.
- Redesigned documentation information architecture using Next.js, MDX, and Tailwind CSS, prioritizing accessibility and streamlined navigation for all user levels to accelerate onboarding.
- Provided hands-on customer training and technical support through in-depth training calls, architectural advice, and rapid troubleshooting (average response time <8 minutes). Optimized integration with 3rd party APIs and services, establishing a reputation as the team's go-to expert.

Developer Experience Engineer | April 2021 - September 2022
Cypress.io | Remote

- Co-authored the Real World Testing with Cypress curriculum, used by thousands of developers globally, to advance industry-standard testing practices (Next.js, MDX, Xstate, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS).
- Drove curriculum adoption and engagement by creating supplementary instructional videos, tutorials, and demos on in-demand topics: Cypress integration (GitHub Actions, 3rd party auth, React/Vue.js component testing).
- Optimized documentation accessibility by restructuring information architecture for new component testing features and leading migration to Docusaurus, improving developer onboarding and reducing customer support volume.
- Built and maintained developer-centric tools, including a VSCode plugin for in-editor Cypress documentation access. Maintained GitHub Actions, CircleCI Orbs, and the "Real World App," enhancing Cypress testing workflows.
- Accelerated the launch of Cypress's component testing feature through rigorous testing, debugging, API design guidance, and the creation of demos and examples for developers to see real examples of how to set up and configure component tests in their apps.
- Collaborated on the website redesign (www.cypress.io), developing new landing pages to enhance user experience, lead generation, and brand messaging.

Senior Software Engineer | December 2018 - April 2021
InsureMyTrip | Remote

- Led the modernization of the front-end toolchain, replacing legacy tools with Webpack, Jest, Cypress, Test Cafe, PostCSS, and VueJS, improving code quality and reducing production bugs. Drove cultural shift toward automated testing, accelerating developer onboarding, and minimizing customer-facing issues.
- Established comprehensive front-end development guidelines (code formatting, linting rules, and standards) enforcing code consistency and maintainability across a 10-member engineering team.
- Partnered with product managers to design and launch a customer-centric quote form, enhancing the travel insurance purchase process. Prioritized stability and ease of use, resulting in a bug-free initial year and reduced development and QA time.

Web Developer | 2017 - 2018
DNL OmniMedia | Remote

- Led the design and development of websites and applications for nonprofits, delivering responsive and user-centric experiences tailored to drive business goals.
- Architected scalable front-end build systems (Webpack, Gulp) for clients, streamlining development workflows and reducing time-to-market.

Front-End Developer | 2015 - 2017
inMusic Brands | Cumberland, RI

- Led front-end development across a portfolio of 14+ company websites, ensuring brand consistency, accessibility, and optimal user experience. (HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, jQuery, Foundation Framework).
- Built high-converting microsites and landing pages for product launches, increasing lead generation and campaign ROI.
- Developed cross-client compatible, responsive HTML emails, contributing to a significant improvement in open rates.

Additional Experience: Web Developer | 2014 - Current | Freelance | Remote

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Music | Magna Cum Laude | May 2013
Berklee College of Music | Boston, MA